Johannes Hirvonen

CONTACT

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EDUCATION

Northwestern University, Evanston, IL, USA 2023–Present
Ph.D. in Economics (Fields: Industrial Organization, Labor Economics)
M.A. in Economics, 2024 (awarded en route to Ph.D.)

Aalto University, Espoo, Finland 2019–2021
M.Sc. in Economics (with distinction)

Aalto University, Espoo, Finland 2015–2019
B.Sc. in Economics (with distinction)

WORKING PAPERS

What Do Technology Grants Do? [link]
with Aapo Stenhammar and Joonas Tuhkuri.
Conditionally accepted at the Quarterly Journal of Economics

- Featured in The Economist (article, leader) and Wired.

Traps and Springboards: The Mobility Effects of Crisis Subsidies [link]
with Otto Kässi and Olli Ropponen.

- Won the Susan Schmidt Bies Prize (2026) for the best third-year policy paper, Northwestern Economics.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Rating Design and Consumer Exploration

Lowering the Bar: Review Costs and the Informativeness of Online Ratings

From Exploration to Refinement: How Patent Grants Redirect Inventors
with Joakim Wikström.

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Susan Schmidt Bies Prize	2026
Finnish Cultural Foundation	2025
Yrjö Jahnsson Foundation	2023, 2025
Emil Aaltonen Foundation	2024
Foundation for Economic Education	2021, 2023
Northwestern University Fellowship	2023
Employee Foundation (Palkansaajasäätiö)	2023
HSE Support Foundation	2022
Fulbright Scholarship	2021

SELECTED CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

(indicates presentation by coauthor)*

NBER Economic Analysis of Business Taxation Meeting (2025)*, AEA Annual Meeting (2023)*, Econometric Society European Winter Meeting (2022)*, NBER Summer Institute, IT&D (2022)*, AI-Econ Lab (2022), Euroframe (2022), Ministry of Economic Affairs and Employment in Finland (2022), Etla Economic Research Seminar Series (2021)

EMPLOYMENT

Etla Economic Research, Helsinki, Finland — Researcher, 2022–2023

Etla Economic Research, Helsinki, Finland — Research Trainee, 2019–2021

Aalto University, Espoo, Finland — Teaching Assistant, 2019–2020
Courses: *Intermediate Microeconomics*, *Microeconomics: Pricing and Strategy*, *Money and Banking*

Aalto University, Espoo, Finland — Research Assistant, 2019

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee: *Journal of Public Economics*
Vice President, Aalto Economics Student Organization, 2020–2021

POLICY REPORTS

Unless otherwise noted, reports are in Finnish.

The Effects of Covid-related Business Subsidies in Finland [link]
with Olli Ropponen, Heli Koski, Otto Kässi, Nelli Valmari, and Ilkka Ylhäinen, February 2024.

Business Finland COVID-19 Support Funding – What Was Achieved, and at What Cost? [link]
with Otto Kässi and Olli Ropponen, December 2023.

Did Digitalization Increase the Resilience of Societies During the COVID-19 Pandemic? [link]
with Otto Kässi, Jyrki Ali-Yrkkö, and Mika Pajarinen, March 2023.

Are Global Value Chains Changing? [link]
with Jyrki Ali-Yrkkö and Mika Pajarinen, February 2023.

Policy Brief: New Evidence on the Effect of Technology on Employment and Skill Demand [link]
with Aapo Stenhammar and Joonas Tuhkuri, April 2022.

In Search of Upcoming Supply Chain Surprises: The World Export Market Shares of Belarus, Russia and Ukraine (in English) [link]
with Jyrki Ali-Yrkkö and Petri Rouvinen, March 2022.

The Significance of Russia for Finnish Companies [link]
with Jyrki Ali-Yrkkö and Aki Kangasharju, March 2022.

COMPUTING

Python, Stata, text-based machine learning (language-model embeddings, text-based propensity scores), high-performance computing (Slurm), web data collection, LaTeX, Claude Code

BASIC INFORMATION

Citizenship: Finland (EU)
Languages: English (fluent), Finnish (native)
Military Service: Finnish Defence Forces (2016–2017)